



The Prefix sub-

I can add sub- to make a new word.



Today I am learning to:

- ☐ understand what **sub-** means
- ☐ add **sub-** to base words
- ☐ read and use new words
- ☐ use the words in sentences

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Learn the Rule

The prefix **sub-** means **under, below or less than**.

When we add **sub-** to a base word, we make a new word that means **under, below or less than**.

sub- = under, below or less than



submarine

a boat that goes under water



subsoil

soil below the top layer



subway

a train that travels below the ground



subtract

take away (make less)

2

Add sub-

Write the new word.

1. marine sub _____



2. way sub _____



3. soil sub _____



4. zero sub _____



5. merge sub _____



6. standard sub _____



3

Match the Meaning

Draw a line to match each word with its meaning.

- | | | | |
|-------------|---|---|------------------------------|
| submarine | • | • | take away (make less) |
| subway | • | • | a train below the ground |
| subsoil | • | • | under the soil |
| subtract | • | • | go under water |
| submerge | • | • | below the normal standard |
| substandard | • | • | a boat that goes under water |

4

Choose the Correct Word

Tick (✓) the word that makes sense.

- | | | |
|--|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| 1. The ____ went under the water. | ☐ submarine | ☐ subway |
| 2. We took 5 away, so we had to ____. | ☐ submerge | ☐ subtract |
| 3. The plant's roots grow in the ____. | ☐ subsoil | ☐ substandard |
| 4. We caught the ____ to the city. | ☐ subway | ☐ submerge |
| 5. This toy is ____ the water. | ☐ submarine | ☐ substandard |

5

Use the Words

Write a sentence for each picture using a word with **sub-**.

1.  _____

2.  _____

3.  _____

Word Bank

submarine subsoil submerge
subway subtract substandard



Challenge

Choose a base word of your own. Add **sub-** and write a sentence with the new word.

One small prefix
can make a big difference!

